

MATH 2102 Linear Algebra II

Chapter 5

More About Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors

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Chapter 5: More About Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors

- A Spectral theorem
- B Eigenvalues of different operators
- C Singular values
- D Generalised eigenvectors
- E Nilpotent operators
- F Two famous theorems

A1. Setting the scene

In this chapter, we continue to assume that V and W are finite-dimensional inner product spaces over $\mathbb{F}$ (and work with the standard inner product in case the inner product space is $\mathbb{F}^n$), unless the content suggests otherwise.

A2. Orthogonal diagonalisation

One of the main goals in studying eigenvalues and eigenvectors for an operator $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ is to find a basis of V containing eigenvectors of T . If such basis exists, T is said to be diagonalisable.

If V is an inner product space, it would be even nicer if we could find an **orthonormal** basis of V containing eigenvectors of T . If such basis exists, T is said to be unitarily diagonalisable, or in case $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{R}$, orthogonally diagonalisable.



A3. Eigenvalues and eigenvectors of self-adjoint and normal operators

$$T = T^*$$

(a) Let $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ be self-adjoint. Then every eigenvalue of T is real.

Proof:

Suppose $T(\mathbf{v}) = \lambda \mathbf{v}$ where $\mathbf{v} \neq \mathbf{0}$. Consider $\langle T(\mathbf{v}), \mathbf{v} \rangle$.

$$\langle T\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{v} \rangle = \langle \lambda \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{v} \rangle = \lambda \|\mathbf{v}\|^2$$

$$= \langle \mathbf{v}, T^* \mathbf{v} \rangle$$

$$= \langle \mathbf{v}, T\mathbf{v} \rangle$$

$$= \overline{\lambda} \|\mathbf{v}\|^2$$

$$\rightarrow \text{i.e. } \lambda = \overline{\lambda} \rightarrow \lambda \in \mathbb{R}.$$

A3. Eigenvalues and eigenvectors of self-adjoint and normal operators

$$TT^* = T^*T,$$

(b) Let $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ be normal. Then

λ is an eigenvalue of T if and only if $\bar{\lambda}$ is an eigenvalue of T^* .

Proof:

For a non-zero vector $\mathbf{v}$, we want to show that $T(\mathbf{v}) = \lambda\mathbf{v} \iff T^*(\mathbf{v}) = \bar{\lambda}\mathbf{v}$.

Note that for any $k \in \mathbb{F}$, $T - kI$ is also normal since

$$\langle (T - \lambda I)\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{v} \rangle = 0 = \langle \mathbf{v}, (T^* - \bar{\lambda} I)\mathbf{v} \rangle$$

A3. Eigenvalues and eigenvectors of self-adjoint and normal operators

(c) Let $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ be normal. Then eigenvectors of T corresponding to distinct eigenvalues are orthogonal.

Proof:

Suppose $T(\mathbf{v}_1) = \lambda_1 \mathbf{v}_1$ and $T(\mathbf{v}_2) = \lambda_2 \mathbf{v}_2$ where $\lambda_1 \neq \lambda_2$ and $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2 \neq \mathbf{0}$. Now

$$\begin{aligned}
 \langle T(\mathbf{v}_1), \mathbf{v}_2 \rangle &= \langle \mathbf{v}_1, T^*(\mathbf{v}_2) \rangle \\
 &\stackrel{\downarrow}{=} \langle \lambda_1 \mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2 \rangle & \stackrel{\downarrow}{=} \langle \mathbf{v}_1, \overline{\lambda_2} \mathbf{v}_2 \rangle \\
 &= \lambda_1 \langle \mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2 \rangle & = \overline{\lambda_2} \langle \mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2 \rangle \\
 &\stackrel{\downarrow}{=} \langle \mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2 \rangle = 0
 \end{aligned}$$

A4. Spectral theorem on $\mathbb{R}$

Lemma

Let $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ be self-adjoint. Then there exists a basis $\mathcal{B}$ of V for which $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$ is upper triangular.

(con) $\therefore m_T \cdot (T^2 - bT + cI)^{-1}$ has less degree but still equal to 0.

Proof:

We only have to consider the case $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{R}$. If the result is not true, then m_T has a quadratic factor $t^2 - bt + c$ where $b^2 < 4c$. This would lead to a contradiction

since Lemma: T is self-adjoint $\iff \forall b^2 < 4c, T^2 - bT + cI$ is invertible.

$$\forall v \in V, \langle (T^2 - bT + cI)v, v \rangle = \langle Tv, Tv \rangle + b\langle Tv, v \rangle + c\langle v, v \rangle$$

$$\geq \|Tv\|^2 - |b|\langle Tv, v \rangle + c\|v\|^2$$

$$\geq \|Tv\|^2 - |b| \cdot \|Tv\| \|v\| + c\|v\|^2$$

$$= \left(\|Tv\| - \frac{|b|}{2}\|v\| \right)^2 + \left(c - \frac{b^2}{4} \right) \|v\|^2 > 0$$

i.e. $\exists v \neq 0$ s.t. $(T^2 - bT + cI)v = 0 \rightarrow \sim \exists$ injective $\rightarrow \sim$

A4. Spectral theorem on $\mathbb{R}$

Spectral theorem on $\mathbb{R}$

Suppose $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ and $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{R}$. Then T is orthogonally diagonalisable if and only if T is self-adjoint.

Proof:

($\Rightarrow$) Easy.

($\Leftarrow$) Take a basis $\mathcal{B}$ for which $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$ is upper triangular. Turn $\mathcal{B}$ into an orthonormal basis $\mathcal{E}$. Then $[T]_{\mathcal{E}}$ is upper triangular, and hence diagonal, since

Gram-Schmidt process.

$$\text{and } [T]_{\mathcal{E}} = [T^*]_{\mathcal{E}} = [T]_{\mathcal{E}}^{\dagger}$$

A5. Spectral theorem on $\mathbb{C}$

Spectral theorem on $\mathbb{C}$

Suppose $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ and $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{C}$. Then T is unitarily diagonalisable if and only if T is normal.

Proof:

($\Rightarrow$) Easy.

($\Leftarrow$) Take a basis $\mathcal{B}$ for which $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$ is upper triangular. Turn $\mathcal{B}$ into an orthonormal basis $\mathcal{E}$. Then $[T]_{\mathcal{E}}$ is upper triangular, and hence diagonal, since

$$[T]_{\mathcal{E}} = \begin{bmatrix} a_{1,1} & a_{1,2} & \dots \\ 0 & a_{2,2} & \dots \\ \dots & \dots & \dots \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\|Te_i\| = |a_{1,1}|^2$$

$$\|T^*e_i\| = |a_{1,1}|^2 + |a_{1,2}|^2 + \dots = \|Te_i\|$$

A6. Some numerical examples

Consider $T : \mathbb{R}^3 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$ with standard matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 14 & -13 & 8 \\ -13 & 14 & 8 \\ 8 & 8 & -7 \end{bmatrix}$. We have

$$T(1, -1, 0) = 27(1, -1, 0)$$

$$T(1, 1, 1) = 9(1, 1, 1)$$

$$T(1, 1, -2) = -15(1, 1, -2)$$

A6. Some numerical examples

Consider $T : \mathbb{C}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^2$ with standard matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 2 & -3 \\ 3 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$. We have

$$T(i, 1) = (2 + 3i)(i, 1)$$

$$T(-i, 1) = (2 - 3i)(-i, 1)$$

Chapter 5: More About Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors

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B1. An intuitive overview

We can intuitively associate operators on V to complex numbers via their eigenvalues. Different operations and types of operators are thus associated with the corresponding operations and types of complex numbers as follows:

Adjoint	$\longleftrightarrow$	Complex conjugation
Self-adjoint operators	$\longleftrightarrow$	Real numbers
Unitary operators	$\longleftrightarrow$	Complex numbers with modulus 1
Positive operators	$\longleftrightarrow$	Non-negative real numbers

B2. Eigenvalues of unitary operators

Let $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ be unitary. Then every eigenvalue of T has modulus 1.

Proof:

Suppose $T(\mathbf{v}) = \lambda \mathbf{v}$ where $\mathbf{v} \neq \mathbf{0}$. Since a unitary operator is an isometry, we have

$$|\langle T\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{v} \rangle| = |\langle \lambda \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{v} \rangle| = |\lambda| |\langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{v} \rangle| = |\lambda| \|\mathbf{v}\|^2 = \|\mathbf{v}\|^2$$

$$|\lambda| = 1$$

B2. Eigenvalues of unitary operators

Since a unitary operator $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ is normal, it follows from the spectral theorem that it is unitarily diagonalisable. Together with the previous result, we know that there exists an orthonormal basis $\mathcal{E}$ of V such that $[T]_{\mathcal{E}}$ is a diagonal matrix whose diagonal entries has modulus 1. Is the converse true?

B3. Eigenvalues of positive operators

Let $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ be positive. Then every eigenvalue of T is non-negative.

Proof:

Suppose $T(\mathbf{v}) = \lambda \mathbf{v}$ where $\mathbf{v} \neq \mathbf{0}$. Since T is positive, we have

$$\langle T(\mathbf{v}), \mathbf{v} \rangle \geq 0$$

$$\lambda \|\mathbf{v}\|^2 \geq 0,$$

$$\lambda \geq 0.$$

B3. Eigenvalues of positive operators

Since a positive operator $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ is self-adjoint (hence normal), it follows from the spectral theorem that it is unitarily diagonalisable. Together with the previous result, we know that there exists an orthonormal basis $\mathcal{E}$ of V such that $[T]_{\mathcal{E}}$ is a diagonal matrix whose diagonal entries are positive. Is the converse true?

B4. Uniqueness of square root

Let $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ be positive. Then T has a unique positive square root.

Proof:

We have already proved the existence, so let R be a positive square root of T . It suffices to show that whenever $\mathbf{v}$ is a λ -eigenvector of T , we have $R(\mathbf{v}) = \sqrt{\lambda}\mathbf{v}$.

Let $\{\mathbf{e}_1, \mathbf{e}_2, \dots, \mathbf{e}_n\}$ be an orthonormal basis of V consisting of eigenvectors of R , corresponding to eigenvalues $\sqrt{\lambda_1}, \sqrt{\lambda_2}, \dots, \sqrt{\lambda_n}$. Write

$$\mathbf{v} = c_1\mathbf{e}_1 + c_2\mathbf{e}_2 + \cdots + c_n\mathbf{e}_n.$$

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C1. Definition

Let $T \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$. The singular values of T are the non-negative square roots of the eigenvalues of (T^*T) .

Remarks: ①

and self-adjoint.

- T^*T is a positive operator so the above definition makes sense.
- As a convention, the singular values of T are usually written in descending order.
- The multiplicity of a singular value of T is taken to be the dimension of the corresponding eigenspace of T^*T .

we have:

② num of T 's singular value

$$= \dim T^*T$$

③

7.64 T^*T 的性质

设 $T \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$, 那么

- (a) T^*T 是 V 上的正算子;
- (b) $\text{null } T^*T = \text{null } T$;
- (c) $\text{range } T^*T = \text{range } T^*$;
- (d) $\dim \text{range } T = \dim \text{range } T^* = \dim \text{range } T^*T$.

num of T 's non-zero ~

$$= \dim \text{range } T$$

④ T is normal $\rightarrow S_i = 1$
 $\downarrow T^*T = I$

C2. Examples

Find the singular values of the following:

(a) $T : \mathbb{F}^4 \rightarrow \mathbb{F}^4$ defined by

3, 3, 2, 0

$$T(a, b, c, d) = (0, 3a, 2b, -3d)$$

$$M(T) = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 3 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & -3 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$M(T^*) = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 3 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & -3 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$T^*(s, h, i, d) = (9a, 4b, 0, 9d)$$

$$M(T^*T) = \begin{bmatrix} 9 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 9 \end{bmatrix}$$

C2. Examples

Find the singular values of the following:

(b) $T : \mathbb{F}^4 \rightarrow \mathbb{F}^3$ defined by

$$T^*T(a, b, c, d) = (a+b, a+b, 0, 5d)$$

$$T(a, b, c, d) = (-5d, 0, a+b)$$

$$5, \sqrt{2}, 0, 0$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 & -5 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ -5 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 25 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$a+b \geq \sqrt{2} \sqrt{ab}$$

$$\frac{a+b}{a} = \frac{a+b}{b}$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

$25 \quad 0$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

2

C3. Singular value decomposition (SVD)

Suppose $T \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$ and $s_1, s_2, \dots, s_r$ are all the positive singular values of T .

SVD of an operator

There exist orthonormal sets $\{\mathbf{e}_1, \mathbf{e}_2, \dots, \mathbf{e}_r\} \subseteq V$ and $\{\mathbf{f}_1, \mathbf{f}_2, \dots, \mathbf{f}_r\} \subseteq W$ such that

$$T(\mathbf{v}) = s_1 \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_1 \rangle \mathbf{f}_1 + \cdots + s_r \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_r \rangle \mathbf{f}_r.$$

1. $(T^*T)^* = (T^*T) \Rightarrow T^*T$ self adjoint.

By spectral theorem, $\exists$ orthonormal basis $\mathbf{e}_i$ of V such that T^*T 's eigenvalues.

i.e. $\forall i, T^*T \mathbf{e}_i = s_i^2 \mathbf{e}_i$. Let $\mathbf{f}_i = \frac{T \mathbf{e}_i}{s_i}$, then.

$$T(\mathbf{v}) = T\left(\sum \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_i \rangle \mathbf{e}_i\right) = \sim$$

$$\text{and } \forall i, j \quad \langle \mathbf{f}_i, \mathbf{f}_j \rangle = \frac{1}{s_i s_j} \langle T \mathbf{e}_i, T \mathbf{e}_j \rangle$$

C3. Singular value decomposition (SVD)

To prove the result on the previous page, note that by the spectral theorem there exists an orthonormal basis $\{\mathbf{e}_1, \mathbf{e}_2, \dots, \mathbf{e}_n\}$ of V such that

$$(T^* T)(\mathbf{e}_k) = s_k^2 \mathbf{e}_k \quad \text{for every } k \in \{1, 2, \dots, n\}.$$

Take $\mathbf{f}_k = \frac{1}{s_k} T(\mathbf{e}_k)$ for $k \in \{1, 2, \dots, r\}$. We check that

- the set $\{\mathbf{f}_1, \mathbf{f}_2, \dots, \mathbf{f}_r\}$ is orthonormal;
- $(T^* T)(\mathbf{e}_k) = \mathbf{0}$ if $k > r$; and
- $T(\mathbf{v}) = s_1 \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_1 \rangle \mathbf{f}_1 + \dots + s_r \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_r \rangle \mathbf{f}_r$.

C3. Singular value decomposition (SVD)

Consider the linear map $T : \mathbb{F}^4 \rightarrow \mathbb{F}^3$ defined by

$$T(a, b, c, d) = (-5d, 0, a + b).$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & -5 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Can you find the SVD of T ?

$$\begin{array}{cccc} 5 & \sqrt{2} & 0 & 0 \\ \downarrow & \downarrow & \downarrow & \downarrow \\ \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} & \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} & \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} & \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \\ \rightarrow & \rightarrow & \rightarrow & \rightarrow \\ \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} & \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \sqrt{2} \end{pmatrix} & \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} & \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \end{array}$$

$$T(v) = T \left\langle v, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\rangle \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + \sqrt{2} \left\langle v, \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\rangle \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \sqrt{2} \end{pmatrix}$$

C4. SVD for adjoint and pseudoinverse

Suppose $T \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$ and the SVD of T is

$$T(\mathbf{v}) = s_1 \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_1 \rangle \mathbf{f}_1 + \cdots + s_m \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_r \rangle \mathbf{f}_r.$$

Can you work out the SVD of T^* ?

$$T^* T(\mathbf{v}) = \sum s_r \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_r \rangle T^* \mathbf{f}_r = \sum s_r^2 \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_r \rangle \mathbf{e}_r$$

$$\begin{aligned} T^* T \mathbf{e}_r &= s_r^2 \mathbf{e}_r \\ \frac{T \mathbf{e}_r}{s_r} &= \mathbf{f}_r \end{aligned}$$

$$\frac{T^* T \mathbf{e}_r}{s_r} = s_r \mathbf{e}_r$$

$$T T^* \mathbf{f}_r = s_r T \mathbf{e}_r = s_r^2 \mathbf{f}_r$$

$$\frac{T^* \mathbf{f}_r}{s_r} = \frac{T^* T \mathbf{e}_r}{s_r^2} = \mathbf{e}_r$$

$$T^*(\mathbf{w}) = \sum s_r \langle \mathbf{w}, \mathbf{f}_r \rangle \mathbf{e}_r$$

C4. SVD for adjoint and pseudoinverse

Suppose $T \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$ and the SVD of T is

$$T(\mathbf{v}) = s_1 \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_1 \rangle \mathbf{f}_1 + \cdots + s_m \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_r \rangle \mathbf{f}_r.$$

Can you work out the SVD of $T^\dagger$?

$$T^\dagger \mathbf{f}_r = \frac{T^\dagger T \mathbf{e}_r}{s_r} = \frac{\mathbf{e}_r}{s_r}$$

$$(T^\dagger)^* T^\dagger$$

M

SVD of matrix,

$A \rightarrow p \times n$, $\text{rank } A = m \geq 1$.

$\exists$ orthonormal matrix $B \rightarrow p \times m$, $C \rightarrow n \times m$.

all positive element diagonal D

$$A = B D C^*$$

$$B: [\mathbf{f}_1, \dots, \mathbf{f}_m]$$

$$D: \begin{bmatrix} s_1 & & 0 \\ & \ddots & \\ 0 & & s_m \end{bmatrix}$$

$$C: [\mathbf{e}_1, \dots, \mathbf{e}_m]$$

C5. Norm of a linear map

Given $T \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$, define the **norm** of T , denoted $\|T\|$, by

$$\|T\| = \max\{\|T(\mathbf{v})\| : \mathbf{v} \in V \text{ and } \|\mathbf{v}\| = 1\}.$$

It is not hard to see that

- $\|T\|$ is equal to the largest singular value of T ;
 $\|Tv\|^2 = \sum s_i^2 |\langle v, e_i \rangle|^2 \|e_i\|^2 \leq s_1^2 (\sum |\langle v, e_i \rangle|^2) = s_1^2 \|v\|^2$ (largest)
- $\|T\| \geq 0$, equality if and only if $T = 0$;
- $\|\lambda T\| = |\lambda| \|T\|$;
- $\|S + T\| \leq \|S\| + \|T\|$;
- $\|T^*\| = \|T\|$;
- a unitary operator has norm 1.

$$\begin{aligned} \|Tv\|^2 &= \langle Tv, Tv \rangle = \langle v, T^*Tv \rangle \\ &\leq \|v\| \|T^*Tv\| \\ &\leq \|v\| \|T^*\| \|Tv\| \\ \Rightarrow \|Tv\| &\leq \|T^*\| \|v\| \\ \|T\| &= \|Te\| \leq \|T^*\| \|e\| = \|T^*\| \\ &\text{verse } v_{i=0} \end{aligned}$$

C6. Polar decomposition

Let $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$. A **polar decomposition** of T is a factorisation of T in the form

$$T = S\sqrt{T^*T}$$

where S is a unitary operator on V .

$$\begin{aligned} \zeta &= r \cdot e^{i\theta} \\ S v &= \sum \langle v, e_i \rangle f_i \\ T^* T v &= \sum \langle v, e_i \rangle^2 e_i \\ \therefore S \sqrt{T^* T} v &= S \sum \langle v, e_i \rangle e_i = T v. \end{aligned}$$

C6. Polar decomposition

We shall construct a polar decomposition for an arbitrary T . Suppose T has SVD

$$T(\mathbf{v}) = s_1 \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_1 \rangle \mathbf{f}_1 + \cdots + s_r \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_r \rangle \mathbf{f}_r.$$

Separately extend $\{\mathbf{e}_1, \mathbf{e}_2, \dots, \mathbf{e}_r\}$ and $\{\mathbf{f}_1, \mathbf{f}_2, \dots, \mathbf{f}_r\}$ to bases of V . Define

$$S(\mathbf{v}) = \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_1 \rangle \mathbf{f}_1 + \cdots + \langle \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{e}_n \rangle \mathbf{f}_n.$$

Chapter 5: More About Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors

- A Spectral theorem
- B Eigenvalues of different operators
- C Singular values
- D Generalised eigenvectors**
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D1. Setting the scene again

For the rest of this chapter we assume $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ and $\dim V = n > 0$, unless otherwise specified.

Moreover, the results in the rest of this chapter do not depend on an inner product. Hence we can simply regard V to be a finite-dimensional vector space over $\mathbb{F}$.

D2. Some preparatory work

$$\forall v \in \ker T^m, \quad T^{m+1}v = T(T^m v) = 0.$$

- (a) $\ker T^m \subseteq \ker T^{m+1}$ for all non-negative integers m .
- (b) $\ker T^m = \ker T^{m+k}$ for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$ whenever $\ker T^m = \ker T^{m+1}$ for some non-negative integer m .

D2. Some preparatory work

(c) $\ker T^n = \ker T^{n+k}$ for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$.

(d) $V = \ker T^n \oplus \operatorname{im} T^n$.

D3. Definition

Let λ be an eigenvalue of T . We say that a non-zero vector $\mathbf{v}$ is a **generalised eigenvector** of T **corresponding to λ** if $(T - \lambda I)^k(\mathbf{v}) = \mathbf{0}$ for some positive integer k .

Note that

A non-zero vector $\mathbf{v}$ is a generalised eigenvector of T if and only if

$$(T - \lambda I)^n(\mathbf{v}) = \mathbf{0}.$$

D3. Definition

As an example, consider the operator $T \in \mathcal{L}(\mathbb{F}^3)$ defined by (123)

$$T(x, y, z) = (4y, 0, 5z).$$

$$M(T) = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 4 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 5 \end{bmatrix}, \quad M(T - \lambda I) = \begin{bmatrix} -\lambda & 0 & 0 \\ 4 & -\lambda & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 5-\lambda \end{bmatrix}$$

$$0 \rightarrow \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$5 \rightarrow \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} \lambda^2 & 0 & 0 \\ -8\lambda & \lambda^2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & (5-\lambda)^2 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} -\lambda^3 & 0 & 0 \\ 4\lambda^2 & -\lambda^3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & (5-\lambda)^3 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} (-\lambda)^n & 0 & 0 \\ 4(-\lambda)^{n-1} & (-\lambda)^n & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & (5-\lambda)^n \end{bmatrix} \quad 0 \rightarrow 10$$

D4. Properties

(a) If $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{C}$, there exists a basis of V consisting of generalised eigenvectors of T .

Proof:

We prove by induction on n . The result clearly holds for $n = 1$. Suppose $n > 1$ and the result holds for smaller n . Take an eigenvalue λ of T . Then

$$V = \ker(T - \lambda I)^n \oplus \operatorname{im}(T - \lambda I)^n.$$

D4. Properties

(b) If $\mathbf{v}$ is a generalised eigenvector of T , then $\mathbf{v}$ corresponds to a unique eigenvalue.

Proof:

Suppose $\mathbf{v}$ corresponds to both eigenvalues λ and λ' . Take the smallest m for which $(T - \lambda'I)^m(\mathbf{v}) = \mathbf{0}$.

D4. Properties

(c) Generalised eigenvectors of T corresponding to distinct eigenvalues are linearly independent.

Proof:

Take a smallest counterexample, say, T has generalised eigenvectors $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_m$ which are linearly dependent, and they correspond to distinct eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \dots, \lambda_m$ of T . Then there exist scalars $c_1, c_2, \dots, c_m$, **all not zeros**, such that

$$c_1\mathbf{v}_1 + c_2\mathbf{v}_2 + \cdots + c_m\mathbf{v}_m = \mathbf{0}.$$

Chapter 5: More About Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors

- A Spectral theorem
- B Eigenvalues of different operators
- C Singular values
- D Generalised eigenvectors
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E1. Definition and properties

T is said to be a **nilpotent** operator if $T^m = 0$ for some non-negative integer m .

Examples:

- $T(a, b, c, d) = (0, a, b, c)$
- Differentiation on $P_5(\mathbb{R})$

E1. Definition and properties

It is easy to see that

If T is nilpotent, then

- (a) $T^n = 0$;
- (b) Every non-zero vector $\mathbf{v} \in V$ is a 0-generalized eigenvalue of T ;
- (c) 0 is the only eigenvalue of T .

Is the converse true?

E1. Definition and properties

The following are equivalent.

- (a) T is nilpotent. ✓
- (b) The minimal polynomial of T is t^m for some positive integer m .
- (c) There exists a basis $\mathcal{B}$ of V for which $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$ is upper triangular with zeros on the diagonal. ✓

$$\text{if } \exists \sum_{i=0}^{n \leq m} x_i t^i = p = 0$$

$$\text{then } t^{m-n} p = 0. \text{ and } t^{m-n} \cdot t^n \Rightarrow$$

$$\text{i.e. } t^{m-n} \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} x_i t^i = 0$$

$$t = 0.$$

E2. Generalised eigenspaces

If $\mathbf{v}$ is a generalised eigenvector of T corresponding to λ , we define the **generalised eigenspace** of T corresponding to λ , denoted $G(\lambda, T)$, to be

$$G(\lambda, T) = \{\mathbf{v} \in V : (T - \lambda I)^k(\mathbf{v}) = \mathbf{0} \text{ for some positive integer } k\}.$$

Note that $G(\lambda, T)$ is simply the kernel of $\underline{[T - \lambda I]^{\dim V}}$.

Recall the example $T(x, y, z) = (4y, 0, 5z)$.

E2. Generalised eigenspaces

Suppose $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{C}$ and $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \dots, \lambda_m$ are the distinct eigenvalues of T . Then

- (a) $G(\lambda_k, T)$ is T -invariant for every k ;
- (b) $(T - \lambda_k I)_{G(\lambda_k, T)}$ is nilpotent for every k ;
- (c) $V = G(\lambda_1, T) \oplus G(\lambda_2, T) \oplus \dots \oplus G(\lambda_m, T)$.

$$(a) \exists v \in G(\lambda_k, T)$$

$$T(T - \lambda_k I)^m v = 0 = (T - \lambda_k I)^m (Tv),$$

$Tv \in \text{null} \left((T - \lambda_k I)^m \right)$

$$(b) \left((T - \lambda_k I) \Big|_{G(\lambda_k, T)} \right)^{\dim V} = 0.$$

(c)

E3. Block diagonal form

Although not every operator T is diagonalisable, the above results imply that we can find a basis $\mathcal{B}$ of V for which $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$ is in **block diagonal form** where each diagonal block is square and upper triangular.

Illustrate with the example

$$T(x, y, z) = (6x + 3y + 4z, 6y + 2z, 7z)$$

from Chapter 3, where we found that the eigenvalues of T are 6 and 7.

E4. More about square roots of operators

If T is nilpotent, then $I + T$ has a square root.

Proof:

Suppose $T^m = 0$. We look for a square root of T of the form

$$a_0 I + a_1 T + a_2 T^2 + \cdots + a_{m-1} T^{m-1}.$$

$$\sim^2 = a_0^2 I + 2a_0 a_1 T + (2a_0 a_2 + a_1^2) T^2 + \cdots + (2a_{m-1} a_0 + 2a_{m-2} a_1 + \cdots) T^{m-1}$$

$$\text{let } a_0 = 1$$

$$a_1 = \frac{1}{2}$$

$$a_2 = \frac{-a_1^2}{2a_0} = -\frac{1}{8}$$

...



E4. More about square roots of operators

If $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{C}$, every invertible operator T has a square root.

Proof:

For each eigenvalue λ_k of T , we have

$$T_{G(\lambda_k, T)} = \lambda_k I + T_k \quad \text{where } T_k \text{ is nilpotent.}$$

Such operator thus has a square root.

Chapter 5: More About Eigenvalues and Eigenvectors

- A Spectral theorem
- B Eigenvalues of different operators
- C Singular values
- D Generalised eigenvectors
- E Nilpotent operators
- F Two famous theorems**

F1. Algebraic and geometric multiplicities

Let λ be an eigenvalue of T . We define the following:

Algebraic multiplicity of $\lambda = \dim G(\lambda, T)$

Geometric multiplicity of $\lambda = \dim E(\lambda, T)$

Remarks:

- Some authors use the term ‘multiplicity’ for ‘algebraic multiplicity’.
- It is clear from the definition that the algebraic multiplicity is always bigger than or equal to the geometric multiplicity.
- IF $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{C}$, the sum of the algebraic multiplicities of all eigenvalues of T must be equal to $\dim V$.

F1. Algebraic and geometric multiplicities

Consider again the example

$$\begin{bmatrix} 6 & 3 & 4 \\ 0 & 6 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 7 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$T(x, y, z) = (6x + 3y + 4z, 6y + 2z, 7z)$$

where we knew that the eigenvalues of T are 6 and 7. What are the algebraic and geometric multiplicities of the eigenvalues?

F1. Algebraic and geometric multiplicities

Suppose $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{C}$ and let $\mathcal{B}$ be a basis of V for which $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$ is upper triangular. Then the diagonal entries of $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$ are the eigenvalues of T appearing with the same (algebraic) multiplicities.

Proof:

It suffices to show that, if λ is an eigenvalue of T which occurs d times on the diagonal of $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$, then $\ker(T - \lambda I)^n$ has dimension at most d .

Let $\mathcal{B} = \{\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n\}$ and λ_i be the i -th diagonal entry of $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$. For each k ,

$$T(\mathbf{v}_k) = \mathbf{u}_k + \lambda_k \mathbf{v}_k \quad \text{for some } \mathbf{u}_k \in \text{Span}\{\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_{k-1}\}.$$

Suppose 0 occurs d times on the diagonal of $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$. Then nullity T ~~$\leq$~~ d .

F2. Characteristic polynomial

Suppose $\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \dots, \lambda_m$ are the distinct eigenvalues of T , with algebraic multiplicities $d_1, d_2, \dots, d_m$ respectively. We define the **characteristic polynomial** of T , denoted χ_T , by

$$\chi_T(t) = (t - \lambda_1)^{d_1} (t - \lambda_2)^{d_2} \cdots (t - \lambda_m)^{d_m}.$$

Clearly $\chi_T(t)$ is monic and of degree n , and that its zeros are precisely the eigenvalues of T with the same (algebraic) multiplicities.

F2. Characteristic polynomial

Cayley-Hamilton Theorem

When $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{C}$, $\chi_T(T) = 0$ (hence $m_T \mid \chi_T$).

Proof:

Suppose

$$\chi_T(t) = (t - \lambda_1)^{d_1} (t - \lambda_2)^{d_2} \cdots (t - \lambda_m)^{d_m}.$$

It suffices to show that for any k , $\chi_T(T)(\mathbf{v}) = \mathbf{0}$ for all $\mathbf{v} \in G(\lambda_k, T)$.

*dim $G(\lambda_k, T) = d_k$ and $(T - \lambda_k) \big|_{G(\lambda_k, T)}$ is nilpotent.
i.e. $\left((T - \lambda_k) \big|_{G(\lambda_k, T)} \right)^{d_k} = 0$.*

F3. Jordan basis

Show that the following operators are not diagonalisable.

(a) $T : \mathbb{F}^4 \rightarrow \mathbb{F}^4$ defined by

$$T(a, b, c, d) = (0, a, b, c)$$

(b) $T : \mathbb{F}^6 \rightarrow \mathbb{F}^6$ defined by

$$T(a, b, c, d, e, f) = (0, a, b, 0, d, 0)$$

F3. Jordan basis

Despite T being non-diagonalisable, can you find a basis $\mathcal{B}$ for which $[T]_{\mathcal{B}}$ is nice?

(a) $T : \mathbb{F}^4 \rightarrow \mathbb{F}^4$ defined by

$$T(a, b, c, d) = (0, a, b, c)$$

(b) $T : \mathbb{F}^6 \rightarrow \mathbb{F}^6$ defined by

$$T(a, b, c, d, e, f) = (0, a, b, 0, d, 0)$$

F3. Jordan basis

A basis $\mathcal{B}$ of V is said to be a **Jordan basis** for T if

$$A \rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} \lambda & & 0 \\ & \ddots & \\ 0 & & \lambda \end{bmatrix}$$

$$[T]_{\mathcal{B}} = \begin{bmatrix} A_1 & O & \cdots & O \\ O & A_2 & \cdots & O \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ O & O & \cdots & A_k \end{bmatrix},$$

where each A_i is a square matrix such that

- all entries on the main diagonal are the same;
- all entries that are immediately above the main diagonal are 1; and
- all other entries are 0.

F3. Jordan basis

We shall prove that

Every nilpotent operator T has a Jordan basis.

Note that this implies

When $\mathbb{F} = \mathbb{C}$, every operator T has a Jordan basis.

F3. Jordan basis

We prove by induction on n that every nilpotent operator T has a Jordan basis. The result holds for $n = 1$. Assume $n > 1$ and the result holds for smaller n .

Let m be the smallest positive integer such that $T^m = 0$. Pick $\mathbf{u} \in V$ such that $T^{m-1}(\mathbf{u}) \neq \mathbf{0}$. Let U be the span of the linearly independent vectors

$$\mathbf{u}, T(\mathbf{u}), T^2(\mathbf{u}), \dots, T^{m-1}(\mathbf{u}).$$

If $U = V$, we are done. Otherwise, note that U is T -invariant, so it suffices to find a T -invariant subspace W of V such that $V = U \oplus W$.

F3. Jordan basis

Pick $f \in V'$ such that $f(T^{m-1}(\mathbf{u})) \neq 0$. Define

$$W = \{\mathbf{v} \in V : \mathbf{v}, T(\mathbf{v}), \dots, T^{m-1}(\mathbf{v}) \in \ker f\}.$$

We check that

- W is a T -invariant subspace of V ;
- $U \cap W = \{\mathbf{0}\}$; and
- $\dim U + \dim W = n$.